How we built the NDB delivery framework — and how it runs every week.

Mission: honest, usable operational truth with ownership on the person who can act.

Vision: Shine the problem → Suggest the fix → Fix under HITL.

The operating system: gate-train SDLC, Delivery Ops surfaces, weekly NDB Ops KPI rhythm (OnCalls, CFD/CFI), automated EM reminders, and clear RACI.

02 · WHAT PROJECT LIGHTHOUSE IS

One operating system for NDB delivery — so leaders decide, not assemble status.

If you are new here: we did not add another status deck. We wired four capabilities that already run the org's release work into one place.

1 · TRUST THE NUMBERS

- JIRA stays the single source of truth
- We fixed hygiene at the board (not in slides)
- Every count opens the real ticket list
- No "trust me" spreadsheets

2 · RUN THE RELEASE TRAIN

- Shared calendar: planning → ship
- Named gates everyone recognizes
- Hotfixes use a shorter path
- Same UI for every release type

3 · PULSE EVERY WEEK

- Standing NDB Ops weekly review
- OnCalls & customer defects first
- Then blockers, quality, security
- Engineering Managers get auto-nudges

4 · ASSIST, THEN ACT SAFELY

- AI drafts briefs from live data
- Suggestions always show the source
- A human approves before any write
- Never invents ticket IDs

> Next slides unpack the release train, the weekly scoreboard, and who owns each outcome — without assuming you already live in Delivery Ops.

03 · SDLC = RELEASE GATE TRAIN

Hard gates everyone already knows — plus two new soft gates that force readiness early.

Major/minor: **Pre-CC → CC → Pre-EC → EC → Code Complete → CG → PG → GA**. Patch & maintenance skip the long train: **Code Complete + GA only**.

NEW · SOFT	HARD	NEW · SOFT	HARD	HARD	HARD	HARD	HARD
Pre-CC	**CC**	**Pre-EC**	**EC**	**Code Complete**	**CG**	**PG**	**GA**
Design & payload ready before Concept Commit	Concept Commit — release intent locked	Readiness check before Early Commitment	Early Commitment — scope intent locked	Dev done for the train slice	Commit Gate readiness	Promotion Gate readiness	Ship

Where capacity comes in: between **Pre-CC → CC** (and before EC). Size the payload against team engineer-days (PTO, holidays), then bin-pack what fits — so EC is a commitment, not a hope. Capacity Planner / Bin-Packing live as services today; UI is the next beam.

GATE FOCUS	WHO OWNS	WHAT LIGHTHOUSE SHOWS
Pre-CC → CC	RM · FEAT · EM	Release Setup/Config · capacity sizing · bin-pack fit
Pre-EC → EC	FEAT · RM · PM	Feature readiness · Project Status · commit intent
Code Complete → CG → PG → GA	FEAT · Dev EM · QA · RM	Brief · SoS · Risk · Path to Green · forecast

CC = CONCEPT COMMIT (HARD). PRE-CC / PRE-EC = NEW SOFT GATES — NOT JIRA WORKFLOW STATUSES.

Every job in Delivery Ops — what the framework actually does.

JOB	CAPABILITY	SURFACE
See release	FEAT table, Gantt, RAG, outstanding work	Project Status · Feature Dashboard · SoS
Judge health	Release RAG with named blockers / must-fix; green only when clean	Release Brief
Cross-team	Partnership + companion deps; ask vs committed	Dependency View
Sprint truth	Say/do; Dev / QA-verify / Test as three streams	Sprint Report · Sprint Performance
Weekly KPIs	OnCalls, Top/Non-Top CFD & CFI, P0/P1, System Test, Smokes, PreCommits, CVE, Deferral	KPIs · SoS KPI strip
Remind EMs	Scheduled JQL → email (day/time/tz); Generic Reminder	JIRA Emailer schedules
Communicate	Status email, SoS email, weekly update subject, history	Email Sender · Email History
Component heat	Deferral / cleanup / burndown by component	Component Report · System-Test Scale
Ask / learn	AI briefings, leadership asks, chatbot (citations)	Brief · Chatbot · SoS by Leader
Govern	Release create/rename, gate config, teams/RBAC	Release Setup/Config · Admin

05 · WHAT WAS NOT WORKING

Fog = broken truth + wrong RACI + no weekly scoreboard.

BROKEN TRUTH

- Inconsistent fields — Status / FixVersion / Component / Type
- Resolved treated as done (it is TBV)
- 17+ apps / Slack / Excel for one story
- Capacity workbook with `#REF!` cells
- OnCalls / CFDs invisible until someone asked

BROKEN OPERATING RHYTHM

- TPM assembled narrative FEAT should own
- EMs not nudged on stale / open queues
- No standing weekly KPI pulse for Ops
- Partners couldn't see NDB asks
- Gate slips without named owner

> If OnCalls and CFDs only surface in a fire drill, the framework failed. Weekly Ops exists so those numbers are routine — not exceptional.

Fix the board. One surface. Cadence. Then assist.

249
JCH filed (NDB eng reporters)

239
shipped board/process changes

17→1
app fog → Delivery Ops jobs

0 invent
ticket keys in AI for exec trust

SHIFT	FROM	TO
Truth	Interpret JIRA creatively	JCH-enforced fields, workflows, versions
Surface	Build another status app	One Delivery Ops OS on the gate train
Ownership	TPM owns green/red story	FEAT owns Risk Indicator; tool shows receipts
Cadence	Ad-hoc KPI asks	Weekly NDB Ops on OnCalls / CFD / CFI / …
EM assist	Hope people remember	Scheduled reminder emails from live JQL
Velocity	One blended number	Dev · QA verification · Test streams

> Executives get outcomes (counts by theme). Ticket lists stay in JCH for TPM audit — not this room.

Standing weekly focus — OnCalls, CFDs, and the KPI scoreboard.

Configured NDB KPI chips (clickable to JIRA). Same set surfaces in SoS. This is the weekly Ops pulse — not a one-off report.

OnCalls project=OnCall — interrupt load every week	**Top-CFD** Top customer-facing defects	**Top-CFI** Top customer-facing improvements	**Non-Top CFD / CFI** Breadth of defect/improvement backlog
Product Blockers (P0) ERA P0 bugs	**Product Criticals (P1)** ERA P1 bugs	**System Test** System-test filter pulse	**Smokes** Smoke health
NDB PreCommits Pre-commit failures / load	**CVE** Security queue	**Deferral** Explicitly deferred work	**+ SoS / Brief** Release RAG + must-fix beside KPIs

Weekly Ops contract: look at OnCalls + CFD/CFI first, then P0/P1, then quality trains (System Test / Smokes / PreCommits). Decisions stay with EM / QA / FEAT — Lighthouse only lights the board.

SOURCE: KPICONFIG.JSON · /KPIS · SOS KPI STRIP

Nagging is a system job. Judgment stays with the EM.

WHAT WE AUTOMATED

- Generic Emailer: JQL → table → SMTP
- Schedules: day · hour · minute · timezone
- Recipients + optional project-team expand
- Email History audit (generic-reminder type)
- Same pattern for weekly / recurring EM nudges

WHAT EMS STILL OWN

- Act on the queue (close, defer, reassign)
- Say/do and sprint hygiene
- Capacity / commit honesty for their team
- Respond to partner dependency asks
- Risk Indicator when Yellow/Red on their FEATs

CADENCE EXAMPLE	PURPOSE	OWNER AFTER SEND
Scheduled reminder	Stale / open / OnCall / CFD slices land in EM inbox without TPM chase	EM
Monday weekly status	3-tier leadership digest (release → team → FEAT callouts)	TPM sends · leaders read
SoS / Brief send	Staff-meeting truth + email from same dataset	TPM/RM distribute
Friday leader email	Planned: SoS-by-leader coaching snapshot	Eng leader

Tool assists. Humans decide.

PHASE	LIGHTHOUSE DOES	HUMAN DOES
Pre-CC → CC → EC	Capacity size + bin-pack; gates; feature readiness	RM/FEAT/EM set dates & commit what fits
Build (sprints)	Say/do, three velocity streams, carry-over, EM reminders	EM re-plans; IC delivers
Verify	QA lag, System-Test Scale, weekly quality KPIs	QA closes TBV; owns bandwidth
CG → PG	Brief RAG, must-fix, Path to Green, deps	FEAT owns risk; partners accept asks
Weekly Ops	OnCalls · CFD/CFI · P0/P1 · CVE · Deferral chips	Ops + EMs triage and assign
GA / Learn	Retrospective, forecast, AI asks, chatbot	Ship/slip; HITL on any mutate

10 · FIXING RACI

Accountability on the person who can change the outcome.

ARTIFACT	WAS	NOW
“Is the release green?”	TPM slide archaeology	**A:** FEAT (Risk Indicator) · **I:** exec via Brief/SoS
OnCalls / CFD weekly	Whoever remembered to check	**A:** EM / Ops on KPI pulse · tool shows chips
EM queues	TPM chase on Slack	**R:** scheduler reminds · **A:** EM acts
Cross-team ask	Side meeting	**A:** FEAT/TPM · partner sees Dependency View
Sprint honesty	Blended velocity	**A:** EM say/do · **A:** QA verification lag
Gate move	Silent field edit	**A:** RM/FEAT + reason

> **A** Accountable · **R** Responsible · **I** Informed. Lighthouse informs and reminds — it does not steal ownership.

11 · HOURS BACK → DOLLARS · DATA FROM SAVINGS.MD

Full org — TPM, EM×8, Dir/VP, capacity. Hours first, then CTC.

$ = hrs/wk × people × 52 × (CTC ÷ 2,080). Default CTC median **~$150k** (~$72/hr). Geo bands: US ~$300k · India ~$150k · Mexico ~$75k.

ROLE	RITUAL HRS (EACH)	PEOPLE	HRS/WK	HRS/YR	$/YR @ $150K CTC	STATUS
TPM / RM	10 (3.5 Brief + 2 email + 2.5 chase + 1.5 KPI + 0.5 stitch)	1	10	520	**~$37k**	Accruing
EM	5 (2 queue + 2 KPI hunt + 1 status)	8	40	2,080	**~$150k**	Accruing
Director / VP	3 (1.5 staff stitch + 1 clarify + 0.5 ad-hoc KPI)	1	3	156	**~$11k**	Accruing
Capacity owners	~4 avg (H2 workbook cycle)	1	~4	~210	**~$15k**	Still ahead
Accruing now	TPM + EM×8 + Dir/VP		**53**	**2,756**	**~$199k**	Live rituals

~$199k
/yr @ median CTC — EM×8 is ~75% of the dollars

~$397k
same hours if all US $300k CTC (sensitivity)

~$99k
same hours if all Mexico $75k CTC

Line-item ritual breakdowns: docs/exec-pitch/SAVINGS.md. Not Comp-approved. Not build-cost payback. +capacity → ~$214k @ median.

Run the gate train. Keep the weekly Ops pulse. Fund the next beams.

Framework = Truth (JCH) + Gate SDLC + Weekly KPIs (OnCalls / CFD / …) + EM reminders + RACI.
Still open: living Capacity UI, mutable deps, Sprint Planner, HITL agents, Confluence auto-publish.

Pre-CC → GA | Weekly OnCalls · CFD · CFI | EM scheduled reminders | Shine → Suggest → Fix | One URL in staff